

Return Material Authorisation (RMA) Process

Document ID: sup-rma-process-v1 | Version: 1 | Effective: 2024-02-01 | Owner: Customer Support (Rosa Delgado)

1. Scope

This procedure describes how customers and partners return Halcyon, Tessera and Lumen products to Meridian Instruments for repair, warranty replacement or evaluation. No product may be returned without a valid Return Material Authorisation (RMA) number. Shipments that arrive without an RMA number are refused at goods-in.

2. Requesting an RMA

1. Send an email to rma@meridian-instruments.com with the subject line "RMA request" and the product serial number.
2. Include the model (for example HX-210 or TS4E-NODE-3AX), the fault description, any error code shown (for example E-117 or L-215), the purchase order or invoice number, and the return shipping address.
3. The RMA desk replies within 2 business days with an RMA number in the format RMA-24-NNNNN, for example RMA-24-00731, together with the shipping label and returns address.
4. One RMA number covers up to 10 units of the same model with the same fault. Mixed returns need a separate RMA number per model.

3. Validity

An RMA number is valid for 30 days from issue. Units received after 30 days are held for 10 business days while the RMA desk contacts the customer, and are then returned unrepairs at the customer's cost if no new RMA is requested.

4. Returns addresses

Customer region | Returns location

UK, Europe, Middle East and Africa (EMEA) | Meridian Instruments Ltd, Service Centre, Leeds, United Kingdom

North, Central and South America | Meridian Instruments Inc., Service Centre, Austin, Texas, United States

Asia-Pacific | Meridian Instruments Sdn Bhd, Service Centre, Penang, Malaysia

Write the RMA number clearly on the outside of every carton. Pack gas detectors with their battery installed but switched off. Lumen flow meters must be drained, dried and shipped with flange protection covers fitted.

5. Decontamination

Meridian strongly recommends that a completed decontamination declaration accompanies every return of a product that has been in contact with process fluids, hazardous gases or contaminated environments. Service engineers may delay inspection of products without a declaration until the customer confirms in writing that the product is safe to handle.

6. Advance replacement

Advance replacement is available to Premier support customers only. On approval, a replacement unit is dispatched from regional stock before the faulty unit is received. The faulty unit must then be returned within 30 days, or the replacement unit is invoiced at list price.

7. Assessment and turnaround

On receipt, the service centre inspects the unit and classifies the return as:

- Warranty repair or replacement at no charge.
- Chargeable repair, for which a quotation is sent and must be approved within 15 business days.
- No fault found, which carries an inspection fee of GBP 95 (or local equivalent) for units outside warranty.

The target turnaround is 15 business days from receipt to dispatch for warranty repairs and from quotation approval for chargeable repairs. Calibrated instruments (Halcyon) are returned with a fresh calibration certificate.

8. Shipping costs

For warranty returns, Meridian pays the inbound shipping using the label supplied with the RMA and the outbound shipping. For chargeable repairs, the customer pays inbound shipping and outbound shipping is added to the repair quotation.

9. Contact

Questions about an open RMA should be sent to rma@meridian-instruments.com quoting the RMA number.